

Mohamed Taha

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Work Authorization: U.S. Citizen

Education

George Mason University

B.A.S. in Cybersecurity

Clubs: Hack Overflow | Competitive Cyber at Mason | Archery | Kendo

Expected Graduation: 2027

Northern Virginia Community College

A.A.S. in Cybersecurity | GPA: 4.0

Graduation Date: May 12, 2025

- Presidential Scholar Honoree (3x)
- Dean's List Honoree (2x)

Professional Experience

Cybersecurity Intern

Lionfish Cyber Security / Meerkat Cyber / NDIA

August 2025 – Present

- Selected for a competitive internship supporting real-world CMMC Level 2 compliance efforts
- Completed Certified CMMC Professional (CCP) training and passed the certification exam
- Assisted NDIA with CMMC readiness by revising policies and procedures aligned with NIST 800-171 and CMMC
- Used GRC platforms (Lionfish LMS & IntelliGRC) to manage compliance artifacts and documentation
- Supported endpoint onboarding by helping configure new user laptops and access controls
- Collaborated in weekly review meetings and received ongoing mentorship from industry professionals
- Earned a three month internship extension from NDIA based on performance

Agentic AI Intern

Kashmir World Foundation (KWF)

January 2026 – Present

- Exploring and testing agentic AI frameworks like Agno to understand different agent architectures, tools, and control patterns

- Running experiments with multiple LLMs via OpenRouter to compare behavior, tool use, and suitability for agent-based systems
- Writing Python scripts to connect LLM outputs with DroneKit for early-stage drone control and simulation testing
- Experimenting with translating plain-English user prompts into structured drone commands as part of a conversational agent concept
- Working with drone systems and telemetry data to understand constraints around safe and reliable autonomous control
- Documenting findings, test results, and design ideas to guide future agent development and team discussions

Research Experience

Undergraduate Researcher — AI & Agentic Systems

George Mason University, Department of Cybersecurity Engineering

January 2026 – Present

- Conducting a research project on AI and agentic AI systems under faculty supervision within the Department of Cybersecurity Engineering
- Reviewing academic and technical literature on agentic AI, LLMs, and autonomous decision-making systems
- Exploring how agent-based AI systems intersect with cybersecurity, safety, and control considerations
- Collaborating with a faculty research team to define research scope, questions, and potential experimental directions

Cybersecurity Intern

NASA-Funded Summer Research Internship, George Washington University

Safeguarding Autonomous Aircraft in High-Density Urban Airspaces from Cyberattacks

June 2025 – August 2025

- Researched cybersecurity vulnerabilities in autonomous drone software and communication protocols
- Built a virtualized drone test environment using ArduPilot, MAVLink, and Mission Planner to simulate autonomous flight
- Conducted ethical hacking and penetration testing using Kali Linux, including spoofing and man-in-the-middle (MITM) attacks on drone telemetry
- Demonstrated drone redirection and Denial-of-Service (DoS) attacks against the GCS–drone communication link
- Implemented security countermeasures including MAVLink message signing and VPN tunneling with public/private key encryption
- Documented attack methods, findings, and mitigations in a comprehensive research report
- Presented research findings at the NASA ULI Conference (Nashville, TN)

Technical Skills

Programming & Scripting:

Python, Java, HTML

Operating Systems & Virtualization:

Linux (Kali, Fedora, Mint), Windows Server 2019, Windows 11, Virtual Machines

Cybersecurity & Networking Tools:

Metasploit, Nmap, Wireshark, Nessus, Splunk, pfSense,
SentinelOne (Purple AI, AI-powered SIEM — hands on challenges & competition)

Systems & Administration:

Active Directory, User & Permission Management, SSH (PuTTY), Firewall Configuration

Security Concepts & Techniques:

Privilege Escalation, Man-in-the-Middle (MITM) Attacks, Denial-of-Service (DoS) Attacks,
Encryption (BitLocker, PGP), Network Diagnostics

AI & Emerging Technologies:

Agentic AI, Large Language Models (LLMs), OpenRouter, DroneKit, MAVLink

Skills & Languages

Languages:

English (Fluent), Arabic (Fluent)

Soft Skills:

- Problem Solving | Critical Thinking | Time Management
- Leadership | Communication | Collaboration
- Adaptability | Organization | Attention to Detail
- Fast learner, passionate about continuous learning and cybersecurity

Certifications

- CompTIA Linux+ (Earned)
- Certified CMMC Professional (CCP)

Volunteer Experience

Mosque

- Prepared and served food to the needy during Iftar/Ramadan
- Helped create flyers and manage social media accounts for fundraising